THE GATHERING PLACE

The Gathering Place

A place for creatives who are done performing.

FOUNDING COHORT · 2026 · INVITATION ONLY

WHERE THIS CAME FROM

Twenty Years on Stage, and a Question He Kept Asking

Drew Dudley has given more than 1,000 speeches over twenty years. Fifteen years with the same company. A career built on showing up in rooms and being exactly what those rooms needed him to be.

At some point, the rooms started to feel the same.

> *"I realized my brain hadn't said 'oh, that's interesting' about being on stage in a while."*

The realization wasn't that speaking was the wrong career. It was that he'd spent twenty years building a brand that was entirely dependent on him — on his presence, his energy, his willingness to show up and perform. And there was almost nowhere in that career where he could stop performing.

When he sat down to design what his ideal life actually looked like, the answer kept coming back to the same image: gathered around a fire with people he found genuinely interesting. No agenda. No performance pressure. Just people who could sit in a room together, go quiet when they needed to, and pick up a conversation at 2am if the energy was right.

The Gathering Place is that image turned into a business.

> *"Can I create a place where people feel safer and freer to be their sort of weirder creative selves? Creatives who are business people can't be weird offstage. We have to be what they want — and then sometimes it's hard to separate the two. I want to build a place where you don't have to explain it."*

A PRIVATE CREATIVE CLUB

Not a Conference. Not a Mastermind. Not an Event.

WHAT IT IS	WHAT IT ISN'T
A physical, membership-based space	~~A conference~~
A rotating set of high-end properties	~~A mastermind group~~
A small, hand-picked community of creatives	~~A co-working space~~
A place to think, work, and be around people who get it	~~An event series~~
Unstructured enough that real things can happen	~~A structured curriculum~~
Curated enough that nobody wastes anyone's time	~~A networking club~~

The closest analogy Drew offered: "a year-long conference drop-in, entirely run by your energy."

Members are hand-picked. The founding cohort is people Drew has had 2.5-hour first calls with — the kind of people where you don't have to explain yourself. They already get it.

The Gathering Place is also a brand play. Drew has spent twenty years building the "Drew Dudley" brand — but that brand is dependent on his personal labor and presence. The Gathering Place is designed to be scalable. An organic community that can grow, be handed off, and outlast him.

HOW WE ARE TOGETHER

Not Rules. A Culture.

Smart, excited, talky people are bad at listening to each other. These principles exist to slow the room down enough for something real to happen.

No performance required.

You don't have to be "on." Nobody here needs you to be impressive. Leave the stage persona at the door. That's the whole point.

Pause before answering.

A beat of reflection before speaking. It sounds small. It changes everything — you'll find yourself saying things you actually mean instead of things you've already rehearsed.

Ask more than you answer.

The most interesting people in any room are the ones who want to know more than they want to be known.

Don't speak for more than 90 seconds straight before 5pm.

A cultural nudge, not a rule. Talky people can fill every room. This slows things down enough for something unexpected to surface.

> THE "AM I CRAZY" ROOM
>
> Every location has a designated space — a chair, a corner, a spot by the fire. If someone is in it, it means one thing: *I have an idea I want someone to hear*. You don't get to spew your ideas at people. But if you're in the chair, anyone can come sit across from you — and if you do, you're agreeing to listen first and react second. Nobody gets ambushed. Nobody wanders in by accident.

By the fire, none of the above applies. You can just be.

2026 – 2027

The Locations

The Gathering Place is a beta program. The first year is Drew proving the concept, stress-testing the model, and building the founding cohort. Locations rotate throughout the year — from a Toronto base to a cottage in the Kawarthas, a winter residency in Barbados, and eventually a permanent inner-circle home in Cape Breton overlooking the ocean.

Feb 15–20, 2026

Forest Hill, Toronto

TORONTO, ONTARIO

Pilot week. Invite-only drop-in. The first real gathering — proving the concept in a room before anything goes public.

April – mid May 2026

Toronto (Permanent Home)

TORONTO, ONTARIO

A property Drew made an offer on as of early 2026. If the offer comes through, this becomes the base of operations.

May – October 2026

The Kawarthas

KAWARTHAS, ONTARIO

A cottage his family lost to bankruptcy 20 years ago that he swore he would one day buy back. It became available.

November 2026

The Icon, Toronto

TORONTO, ONTARIO

Return to the city for late fall.

January – March 2027

Barbados

BARBADOS

A property Drew has access to. The winter residency.

TBD

Cape Breton, Nova Scotia

CAPE BRETON ISLAND, NOVA SCOTIA

A property on a cliff overlooking the ocean outside Chéticamp. Planned as the permanent inner-circle home for founding members.

YOUR MEMBERSHIP

What You Get

Physical Access to the Space

Stay at any of the rotating properties. Book a room, use it as an office, host client meetings in the space. Having access to a beautiful, distraction-free environment outside your home or office is worth the cost of membership for a lot of people on its own.

Professional Video Studio

An on-site, professionally managed studio is included at every location — lighting, sound, setup handled. Keynotes, presentations, social content, course material. No more booking studios in random cities or filming on your phone.

Social Media Production

Content creation is built into the studio partnership. Members who want finished social content — not just raw footage — have access to production support as part of their membership. Show up with ideas; leave with posts.

Run Your Own Retreats

Bring up to 3 guests for your own programs, workshops, or retreats — and charge those guests directly. If you run a $2,000/head retreat with 3 people, you've covered your monthly membership fee in a single visit. The space becomes a revenue tool.

Drew

He will be there. Not on a schedule. Not delivering a curriculum. But available for speaker coaching, idea-bouncing, and fire-side conversations with someone who's done 1,000 of these. You have to come to him. Members who do tend to get a lot out of it.

5 Questions on Camera Each Visit

Brief, thoughtful answers that become part of The Gathering Place's social content. Members know this going in — it's built into the culture, not a transaction. Everybody contributes a little to the thing that makes the room worth being in.

SUB-BRAND

The Green Room at The Gathering Place

The Gathering Place is open to speakers, coaches, writers, designers, and other creative professionals. But there is an inner track — built specifically for professional speakers.

THE GREEN ROOM

For Professional Speakers

The Green Room is the beating heart of the club — the reason it exists. It carries the same visual identity as The Gathering Place, with a distinguishing mark, the way a military unit wears a badge on the parent insignia.

It is not publicly advertised. Drew's goal is for it to be so good it develops a waitlist purely by word of mouth.

The Green Room is for people who've stood on enough stages to know what the green room actually feels like — and who want a place that brings that feeling into the rest of their lives.

If The Gathering Place is for creatives who are done performing, The Green Room is for the people who built their whole career performing — and need the deepest version of the permission to stop.

MEMBERSHIP

The Founding Cohort

The founding cohort is 8 to 12 people. Hand-picked. Drew is not filling seats — he's curating a room he wants to live in. If only 8 members join, the other 4 seats sit empty until the right person appears.

$2,500

PER MONTH · ~$30,000 / YEAR

Terms are completely flexible. Drew has floated $500/month for the right person. He's building this to be extraordinary, not to maximize revenue in year one.

The pitch Drew makes to everyone: *"Could you generate $20,000–$25,000 in new business or revenue over the year if you had access to a world-class space, a professional studio, and a room full of people at this level?"*

Most people he asks that question to say yes immediately.

Break-even is 6 members. The model is financially sustainable from there. Everything beyond that is investment back into the spaces, the studio, and the experience.

Drew's framing: *"It's like you put 12 people together and take $100,000 and put it into their careers. You want to see what I can do with that? Just watch."*

SELF-SELECTION

Is This For You?

The Gathering Place is not for everyone. It doesn't need to be. It needs to be exactly right for a small number of people.

- You're a speaker, coach, writer, designer, or other creative professional who has built something real — and you're ready to be around people at that level.
- You spend a lot of energy showing up the way other people need you to show up. You're ready for a room where you don't have to.
- You do your best thinking in conversation, not in isolation — and you're surrounded by people who can't quite keep up with you.
- You've thought about running your own retreats, intensives, or programs but haven't had the space or infrastructure to do it properly.
- You want to leave every visit with usable content — keynote footage, social content, something you can actually put to work.

Request an Invitation

Membership is by invitation only. If this is landing with you, reach out directly.

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